SECURITY THREATS DETECTION INSTITUTE (STDI)

AI Governance Policy

Operational Governance Framework & Risk Mitigation Architecture

Mission Statement	Deploying counter-extremist frameworks that create safe online spaces
Effective Date	1 May 2026
Version	1.0
Approval Authority	STDI Board of Directors
Review Cycle	Annual

1. Purpose

This AI Governance Policy sets out the principles, roles, responsibilities, and processes for the development, procurement, deployment, monitoring, and decommissioning of Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems across the Security Threats Detection Institute (STDI). Our goal is to ensure that AI is used in a responsible, ethical, transparent, and legally compliant manner, maximizing benefit while minimizing harm.

> **STRATEGIC ALIGNMENT:** All AI deployments must strictly align with STDI's core mandate of countering violent extremism while maintaining robust ethical compliance and legal alignment across operating environments.

2. Scope & Applicability

- **Target Audience:** Applies to all employees, contractors, vendors, partners, and third parties who design, develop, procure, manage, or interact with AI systems or offer AI-enabled services on behalf of STDI.
- **Lifecycle Coverage:** Covers all phases of the AI lifecycle: planning, design, training, validation, deployment, operation, monitoring, audit, retirement, or replacement.
- **Deployment Origin:** Applies to both internally built AI systems and externally procured / third-party AI services.
- **Geographic Range:** Applicable across all business units, functions, and geographies in which the organization operates.

3. Guiding Principles

Principle	Description & Implementation Requirement
Accountability & Oversight	There must be clear accountability and governance oversight for AI initiatives; decision-makers must be identifiable and responsible.
Transparency & Explainability	AI systems should be as transparent as possible; where feasible, decisions made by AI should be explainable to affected individuals.
Fairness & Non-Discrimination	AI must avoid unfair bias; models should be tested and validated to ensure they do not discriminate against protected groups.
Privacy & Data Protection	Use of personal or sensitive data must comply with data privacy laws and internal data policies. Techniques such as anonymization, minimization, and encryption should be used.
Robustness & Safety	AI systems must be resilient, tested for adversarial risks, and monitored for performance drift or errors.
Human-in-the-Loop	In critical decisions, humans should have oversight or the ability to override AI outputs.
Compliance & Legal Conformity	All AI system usage must comply with applicable laws (e.g., data protection, discrimination, sectoral regulation) and internal policies.
Continuous Monitoring	AI systems must be monitored during operation; periodic reviews, audits, and recalibration must be in place.

4. Governance Structure & Roles

4.1 AI Governance Board

- **Mandate:** Provide oversight, approve high-risk AI projects, ensure alignment with strategic objectives, and adjudicate escalations.
- **Composition:** Senior leadership from IT, Legal & Compliance, Risk, Data, Ethics, Business, and Counter-Narratives Units.
- **Authority:** Final approval to deploy AI systems defined above risk thresholds, grant exceptions, and enforce compliance.

4.2 Chief AI Officer / AI Governance Lead

- **Role:** Serve as primary owner of AI policy implementation, coordinate with stakeholders, maintain the AI inventory, and ensure compliance and reporting.
- **Responsibilities:** Policy maintenance, audit coordination, liaison with external regulators, oversight of risk assessments, and training governance.

4.3 AI Project Sponsor / Business Owner

The business unit initiating an AI system must appoint a sponsor accountable for aligning the use case with organizational goals, ensuring compliance, and approving budgets and risk mitigations.

4.4 AI Development & Validation Teams

Data scientists, Machine Learning engineers, and validation teams are responsible for model design, testing, validation, documentation, and ongoing monitoring.

4.5 Legal, Compliance & Risk Teams

- Review AI systems for legal, regulatory, and ethical risk (e.g., discrimination, privacy, liability).
- Ensure required documentation, consents, and contractual protections (for third-party systems).

4.6 Audit / Assurance Function

Periodically audit AI systems, validate conformance to policy, and recommend corrections or decommissioning.

4.7 Counter-Narratives Team

- **Threat Intelligence Sync:** Maintain day-to-day communication and coordination with AI Development and Validation Teams to ensure an updated database of key terms, language, and images related to violent extremist groups.
- **Operational Briefings:** Conduct periodic and tailored briefings to all teams regarding the evolving nature of threats posed by violent extremist groups in affected territories and regions.

5. Risk Classification & Approval Workflow

5.1 Risk Tiers

AI systems are categorized based on impact on individuals (health, legal, financial), scale of deployment, data sensitivity, and degree of automation:

- **Low Risk:** Internal productivity tools, non-decision-making systems.
- **Medium Risk:** Customer-facing systems with limited impact.
- **High Risk:** Systems involving legal/health/safety decisions or directly affecting individuals' fundamental rights.

5.2 Approval & Review Paths

Risk Tier	Scope / Examples	Required Approval Path
Low Risk	Internal productivity, non-decision tools	Local team approval + annotation in AI inventory
Medium Risk	Customer-facing tools with limited impact	Review by AI Governance Lead + committee notification

High Risk	Legal, safety, or rights-impacting systems	Full review & explicit approval by AI Governance Committee

5.3 Exception & Exemption Process

Define a controlled process to request exceptions; such requests must include comprehensive risk mitigation plans and undergo rigorous AI Governance Committee review.

6. Data & Model Controls

- **Data Quality & Bias Assessment:** Enforce data validation, provenance tracking, bias detection, and mitigation strategies.
- **Data Privacy & Anonymization:** Use de-identification or pseudonymization where possible. Comply with data protection standards (e.g., GDPR, CCPA).
- **Dataset Segmentation:** Maintain strict separation of training, test, and holdout datasets to guard against data leakage.
- **Model Documentation ('Model Card'):** Each AI system must have a model card detailing purpose, limitations, training data, metrics, maintenance schedule, and known risks.
- **Explainability / Interpretability:** Where feasible, apply techniques (e.g., SHAP, LIME) and require narrative justification for automated decisions.
- **Validation & Testing:** Conduct pre-deployment validation, robustness testing, edge-case simulations, and adversarial testing.
- **Change Control & Versioning:** Maintain strict version control of model code, data, and configurations with structured change reviews.

7. Monitoring, Logging & Incident Management

- **Continuous Monitoring:** Track model performance, detect drift, bias shifts, anomalies, and outputs that deviate from expectations.
- **Logging & Audit Trails:** Maintain comprehensive, immutable logs of inputs, outputs, model versions, user overrides, and system decisions.
- **Incident Response:** Define formal procedures to handle suspected errors, failures, or harms (including rapid rollback, human intervention, and root-cause analysis).
- **Periodic Audit & Review:** At regular intervals (quarterly or annually), audit systems for policy adherence, emerging risks, and recalibration needs.

8. Training, Awareness & Change Management

- **Role-Based Training:** Deliver tailored training modules for developers, business users, executives, and auditors on AI ethics, policy, and compliance.
- **Awareness Campaigns:** Maintain clear communications to employees about AI policy, active use cases, responsibilities, and reporting channels.

- **Change Management:** When introducing significant AI systems, require stakeholder reviews, 'champion' adoption, and continuous feedback loops.

9. Procurement, Vendor & Third-Party AI

- **Due Diligence:** Vendors must share complete model documentation, risk assessments, data provenance, and security assurances.
- **Contractual Protections:** Enforce strict SLAs, audit rights, liability clauses, data handling obligations, and rights to inspect, update, or disable models.
- **Integration Controls:** Require sandbox testing, security reviews, API access control, and runtime limitations (e.g., rate throttling).
- **Ongoing Third-Party Review:** Continuously monitor performance, drift, and policy adherence post-integration.

10. Exceptions, Non-Compliance & Enforcement

- **Exception Process:** Formal procedure to apply for policy waivers, requiring comprehensive justification, risk assessment, and mitigation plan.
- **Escalation Path:** Immediate escalation of non-compliance or policy violations to the Governance Committee, leading to potential system suspension.
- **Corrective Actions:** Protocol includes remediation steps, targeted audits, model retraining, system decommissioning, or user compensation where applicable.
- **Sanctions:** Enforce internal consequences for policy violations (including warnings, role restrictions, mandatory training, or disciplinary action).

11. Policy Review & Updates

- **Review Cycle:** Annual review or sooner upon regulatory updates, technology shifts, or after major incidents.
- **Version Control:** Maintain a strict audit record of versions, specific functional updates, and author attributions.
- **Stakeholder Feedback Loop:** Solicit regular input from business units, legal, technical teams, and end users for continuous policy optimization.

12. Glossary & Definitions

- **AI System:** A machine-based framework that, for explicit or implicit objectives, infers from input data how to generate outputs (predictions, content, recommendations, or decisions) influencing physical or virtual environments.
- **Model Drift:** The degradation of an AI model's predictive accuracy or performance over time due to environmental or behavioral shifts.
- **Explainability:** Ensuring that the outputs and internal decision logic of a machine learning model are understandable and interpretable by human operators.

- **Bias:** Systematic errors within an AI system resulting in unfair or prejudiced outcomes toward specific groups or individuals.
- **Protected Class:** A population segment legally shielded from discrimination under international or local regulations.
- **Adversarial Attack:** Techniques used to trick or manipulate an AI system via deliberately deceptive or modified input data.
- **Human-in-the-Loop:** An interaction framework where an AI system and a human collaborator work within a continuous feedback and decision loop.
- **Extremist Content:** Ideas or materials that advocate for, facilitate, glorify, or incite physical, psychological, or institutional harm.
- **Counter-Narratives:** Proactive communications designed to directly challenge, discredit, or deconstruct the logic of extremist or harmful ideologies.